

Laguna's April 2025 inflation rose slightly to 2.6 percent

SAN PABLO CITY, Laguna - The headline inflation in Laguna increased to 2.4 percent in April 2025 from 2.2 percent in March 2025. This brings the provincial average inflation from January to April 2025 to 2.6 percent.

In April 2024, inflation rate was higher at 2.8 percent.

The uptrend in the overall inflation in April 2025 was primarily influence by the higher year-on- year growth in the commodity group of housing, water, electricity, gas and other fuels at 4.6 percent

TURN TO P. 3

The Wednesday HERALD
website: thewednesdayherald.net
email: heraldgroup96@gmail.com
ONE OF LAGUNA'S OLDEST AND MOST TRUSTED WEEKLY NEWSPAPER
VOL. 44 NO. 28 / MAY 28-JUNE 3, 2025 / LAGUNA PROVINCE & CALABARZON / P12.00 • ISSN: 2599-3984

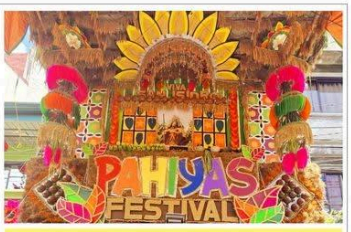
SSS intensifies RACE campaign vs delinquent employers



BY KRISTIANNE ANDRADE

CALAMBA CITY, Laguna — The Social Security System (SSS) intensified the Run After Contribution Evaders (RACE) campaign in Calabarzon to continuously protect the rights of private-sector employees from delinquent employers who fail to remit mandatory monthly contributions.

Turn to p. 6



PhilHealth Regional Office IV-A, nakilahok sa Pahiyas Festival at Arana't Baluarte Festival

LUCBAN AND GUMACA, Quezon (May 15, 2025) — Sa makulay na pagdiriwang ng kapistahan ni San Isidro Labrador-ang patron ng magsasaka, lumahok ang PhilHealth Regional Office IV-A (PRO IV-A) sa dalawang kilalang pista sa lalawigan ng Quezon: ang Pahiyas Festival sa Lucban at ang Arana't Baluarte Festival sa Gumaca. Ang sabayang pakikilahok na ito ay patunay ng dedikasyon ng PhilHealth na palakasin ang presensya nito at itaas ang kamalayan ng miyembro tungkol sa mga programa at benepisyo nito sa makahulugang paraan.

Sa Lucban, ang grupo mula sa Local Health Insurance Office (LHIO) Lucena at regional office ay nakiisa sa libu-libong lokal at turista sa makulay na Pahiyas Festival.

SUNDAN SA P. 3



NAGCARLAN, MAJAYJAY DISTRICT HOSPITALS RECEIVE NEW AMBULANCES



SANTA CRUZ, Laguna – The Nagcarlan and Majayjay district hospitals (NDH, MDH) were each awarded with a new ambulance in a simple turnover ceremony led by DILG-Laguna Provincial Director Jay-Ar T. Beltran, held at the provincial capitol on 19 May 2025.

Said vehicles are from the Seal of Good Local Governance (SGLG) Incentive Fund worth P4 million pesos, earned by the Province of Laguna upon bagging the 2024 SGLG national award of excellence granted by the Department of the Interior and Local Government (DILG) on 10 December 2024 at the Manila Hotel.

Joining PD Beltran were Provincial Administrator Atty. Dulce H. Rebanal, Provincial Health Officer Dr. Rene P. Bagamasbad; Chief of Hospital Dr. Herma Formeloza and Dr. Ma. Teresa Lapitan of NDH and MDH, respectively, as well as their staff. **(Laguna PIO)**

MPT South kicks off Road Safety Month with 'Drayberks: Ready 4 Safety' campaign



With the goal of building a safer future on Philippine roads, Metro Pacific Tollways South (MPT South) marked Road Safety Month by unveiling its latest theme for road safety advocacy campaign "Drayberks: Ready 4 Safety" in a ceremonial launch held at the Golden Phoenix Hotel in Pasay City.

Over 100 stakeholders from both the public and private sectors attended the celebration, in partnership with national agencies including the Department of Transportation (DOTr), Toll Regulatory Board (TRB), Land Transportation Office (LTO), Land Transportation Franchising and Regulatory Board (LTFRB), Metropolitan Manila Development Authority (MMDA), PNP Highway Patrol Group Region IV-A, Philippine Reclamation Authority (PRA), and PEA Tollway Corporation (PEATC). Local government units in Metro Manila and CALABARZON also joined the celebration, including representatives from Taguig, Parañaque, Pasay, Las Piñas, Bacoor, Imus, Kawit, General Trias, Dasmariñas, Silang, Santa Rosa, and Biñan.

TURN TO P. 3

The Wednesday HERALD
website: thewednesdayherald.net
email: heraldgroup96@gmail.com
ONE OF LAGUNA'S OLDEST AND MOST TRUSTED WEEKLY NEWSPAPER
VOL. 44 NO. 28 / MAY 28-JUNE 3, 2025 / LAGUNA PROVINCE & CALABARZON / P12.00 • ISSN: 2599-3984



Enhancing School Sustainability Through Effective Waste Segregation

BY LEANDRO M. CORNISTA
TEACHER III, SAN JOSE INTEGRATED HIGH SCHOOL

The establishment of waste segregation practices delivers an effective method to manage waste within schools. Schools should establish recycling bins for organic waste while schools should instruct students regarding plastic utilization reduction alongside waste recycling programs. The proper separation of plastic, paper and aluminum recycling containers enables both effective material recycling and waste management training for students.

A proper waste segregation system allows students to easily recycle their items while enhancing composting efficiency through effective dry and wet waste separation. Worldwide implementation of proper waste segregation actively minimizes dangerous substances existing in our surroundings while yielding area-wide environmental cleanliness. The practice simultaneously decreases pollution levels and helps protect natural resources to establish sustainable practices within educational institutions and surrounding areas.

The seven steps for minimizing waste include reducing waste, reusing items, recycling materials, composting organic waste, generating energy from burning trash and directing non-recyclable waste toward landfills and stopping all unwanted fires. Several minor activities like donating unused books together with repurposing glass containers and cleaning with old toothbrushes help students create substantial waste reduction outcomes in waste reduction.

Streetwear in the Philippines: More Than Just a Trend, It's a Movement

BY VANESSA LORAINE E. SANCHEZ



If you've been walking around the streets of Philippines like in San Pablo City Laguna, you've probably seen it everywhere, the bold designs on shirts, the oversized tees, the cool sneakers. Streetwear in the Philippines is becoming really popular. But it's more than just about looking good. It's turning into a movement that shows the identity and creativity of the youth today.

For many young Filipinos, streetwear is a way to express themselves. Like me, it's not just about following fashion trends or copying what we see on social media. It's about showing who we are, telling our stories, and breaking away from the usual rules of fashion. Local brands like Don't Blame the Kids (DBTK), Richboyz are leading the way. They mix Filipino culture with modern street style, proving that we can be proud of our roots and still be trendy. zUnlike fast fashion that changes quickly and follows what's "in," Filipino streetwear tells a story. A lot of shirts and designs have deeper meanings they talk about mental health, Filipino pride, or community. Some even include Tagalog words or drawings inspired by things like jeepneys or local icons. Wearing them feels like you're wearing a part of your story.

Streetwear is also opening doors for young people. Many new designers are starting their own brands on social media, especially Tiktok and Instagram. They sell their clothes online or in small events and gain fans along the way. These brands build a strong community where people support and hype each other up. Events like pop-up shops, flea markets, or music fests are now places where fashion, art, and even activism come together.

Social media has helped a lot too. Apps like TikTok and Instagram let Filipino creators show their work to the world. What started small is now getting noticed outside the country, proving that we can compete with international streetwear brands. In a country as colorful and creative as the Philippines, it makes sense that streetwear is more than just clothes. It's a way for young people to be seen, to be heard, and to stand up for what they believe in.

So yeah, streetwear isn't just a trend. It's a statement. A movement. And it shows the world what this generation is all about.

SSS intensifies RACE campaign ...from p. 1

Under the Social Security Act, all employers are mandated to register their businesses and remit monthly contributions for their employees' social security protection benefits.

In a round of surprise visits in Santa Rosa City, Laguna, 10 establishments were given show-cause orders. According to the SSS, these non-compliant employers owe up to ₱6.02 million, which includes principal and penalties.

SSS Luzon 1 Division Vice President Edwin Igharas said the RACE campaign is effective in encouraging non-compliant employers to fulfill their legal obligations.

"It is a big help that employers see a team visiting with SSS account officers, officials, media, and sometimes with police assistance, they will not ignore us," he added.

Moreover, delinquent employers were given a 15-day grace period to comply with their legal duties and to explain their reasons for non-remittance.

Igharas explained, "We understand that some employers go through economic and financial difficulties, we are giving them ways to pay their delinquencies."

He also advised employees to regularly check their monthly contributions online through their MySSS accounts to ensure that these are accurately posted.

"We always tell employees to be vigilant about their contributions. For faster verification, they can check through the SSS website. And if they see discrepancies, they can file a complaint with our office, and we will immediately act on it and make the employers pay the contributions."

Meanwhile, in Bacoor, Cavite, several random businesses were also issued written notices.

According to SSS Bacoor City Acting Head Ms. Lourdes B. Verbo, before the issuance of formal notices, establishments received billing letters and were given ample time to settle their obligations.

She also stressed, "Employers are accountable for the social security protection of their workers."

Meanwhile, the SSS Luzon South 1 Division is targeting to collect ₱135 million in unpaid contributions this year.

Section 22 of the Social Security Act allows the issuance of a Warrant of Distraint, Levy, and Garnishment (WDLG) for the collection of unpaid contributions, including penalties, from delinquent employers. **(RBF/CCM/KDA PIA4A)**

SUDOKU

3				6	9	4	5	
		2				8		6
	1		4				2	3
2		3		9		5		7
	7		3	2				9
	9						3	
8			5	7	3			4
6	3							
7			1	4				

3					9	6		
4	5					9		
6				7				5
		8	2		7	1		
9	1		4				8	2
	7		8				3	
	2	9		8		4	5	
			9	3			1	
				2				

NEM Printing Press
WE SPECIALIZE IN:
NEWS PAPER · NEWS LETTER
MAGAZINE · SCHOOL & OFFICE FORMS
YEAR BOOK · SOUVENIR PROGRAM
BROCHURES · FLYERS · PAMPHLETS
CAMPAIGN MATERIALS AND OTHER PRINTING NEEDS
FREE DELIVERY WITHIN SAN PABLO CITY AREA OR NEARBY PLACES!!!

GRANDEURE
Lights & Sounds
0908 5006399
(049)521 2512
grandeure_gfd@yahoo.com
KEVLER

Heartthrobs Delgado twins on MMA and boxing supremacy



MOMENT OF TRUTH

-- Paolo Manuel C. Fule --

In one of the world's most dangerous sports, it takes a lot of guts, courage, and hard work to attain such discipline in the world of mixed martial arts and boxing. Just like these young lads from Quezon City. They make sure that in every competition they are in, they always give their best and don't forget to thank God for all of their accomplishments.

Born Carlos Miguel Delgado and Gabriel Delgado on September 30, 1999 in Quezon City, the 5-foot-10 and 23-year-old MMA heartthrob and boxing athletes had proven their worth in the arena of warriors. Miguel started learning the sports of MMA at age 17. "I wanted to be bigger and capable of defending myself and the people around me", quipped the young warrior.

Asked about his preparations before, during, and after every game, "I make sure I study my opponents well to prepare for patterns of attack and defense they have. I make sure not to miss a day in training. Discipline gives me confidence. During fights, I keep myself composed. I shut down the negative thoughts inside my head and execute what me and my team have prepared for. After the fight, I get myself checked because for me, health is wealth.", said Gabriel.

Carlos Miguel's achievements in this sport include: Freestyle Wrestling 2 gold medals, 1 Silver medal (10-2), Jiu jitsu: 1 NOGI Gold medal (2-0), MMA: Silver in MMA Grand Prix, 2 - 0 as a Pro-Am, 3 - 0 as an Amateur. As for his coaching from 2017 to present, his records speak for themselves: Muay Thai (6-0), MMA (10-0), Boxing (17-2).

Asked about the advice he can give to those young people who are into this kind of sports, "Napaka hirap ng sport na ito, pero ito ay investment sa sarili natin. Tataas kompyansa mo, gaganda kalusugan mo, ma po protektahan mo ang sarili mo at yung mga tao sa paligid mo. Kung magiging fighter ka napaka lungkot ng sport na ito pero napaka saya pag nanalo ka, basta pag-igihin mo", said Miguel.

With perseverance and unceasing faith in God, the road to glory is not far-fetched for these handsome and young athletes.

Email the author at: paolomanuelfule@yahoo.com



RIBSARAP SAN PABLO CITY: FALL OFF THE BONE RIBS YOU WOULD GO BACK FOR MORE

BY PAOLO MANUEL C. FULE

Are you searching for the best dining experience in the city and want to try something new in your palate? Look no farther as Ribsarap San Pablo City is here. Ribs. Steaks. Wings. You name it, they have it. Add to their delectable menu is their cozy restaurant ambience that's perfect for gathering of family and friends. Their specialty is ribs. Beef ribs are cuts of meat from a cow's ribs, and they come in different varieties like short ribs, back ribs, and chuck ribs. Short ribs are known for their rich flavor and are often braised or cooked low and slow. Back ribs are a delicious, tender cut from the ribeye section while chuck ribs are also known for their rich flavor and are often used for slow-cooked dishes.

The proprietors are Ms. Janna Bati and Mr. Robertson Relucio. Asked about the entrepreneurs' beginnings, "Mahilig kami kumain, nag eexplore kami sa mga bagong bukas na restaurants. So one time, nakita naming yung Ribsarap sa Lipa branch and when we took the meal home, nagustuhan ng mama ko. Then nag usap kami na gusto namin mag franchise. Maganda itong place sa San Pablo City, malapit sa simbahan, sa school, so dun nag start", quipped the owners.

Asked about the customers' response regarding their best sellers, "Masarap naman daw talaga ang food namen, yung ribs sobrang lambot and sobrang malasa".

We had the privilege of dining in Ribsarap San Pablo City and I can totally say that they really delivered one of the best tasting ribs this city has to offer. We had our Ribs with Hungarian fall off the bones ribs with java rice, corn, special bbq sauce, and Hungarian sausage. They also serve steaks, wings, appetizers that include potato wedges, tofu katsu, nacho supreme, chicharon bulaklak, and mozzarella sticks among others.

Ribsarap San Pablo City branch is located at Lauro Dizon Street Brgy. V-D , San Pablo City, Laguna. They are open from 10am to 10pm. For more inquiries, you may email ribsarapsanpablo@gmail.com or call (049) 508 5711. You may follow them on their social media account at facebook: RibSarap - San Pablo City.

Email the author at: paolomanuelfule@yahoo.com



Vol. 44 No. 28
May 28-June 3, 2025
The Wednesday HERALD
https://thewednesdayherald.net
email: heraldgroup96@gmail.com
ONE OF LAGUNA'S OLDEST AND MOST TRUSTED WEEKLY NEWSPAPER



IMPULSES

-- HERMAN M. LAGON --

When numbers fall short

The comeback was anything but predictable. In a race flooded by big names, massive war chests, and heavily publicized machinery, two names clawed their way back into the Senate with minimal fanfare but maximum substance: Bam Aquino and Kiko Pangilinan. It was not just a triumph of strategy or endorsement. It was, more than anything, a quiet but firm vindication of service, credibility, and track record.

Both men had been written off by most pre-election surveys. Pangilinan, once buried in the tail-end of projections, slid into a secure fifth place. Aquino, a supposed long shot, soared to second. This sudden surge, far from being an electoral glitch, mirrored something deeper: a recalibration of trust. And that trust came not from algorithmic targeting or partisan spin, but from the enduring memory of what honest, competent governance looks like.

> "Statistical sampling—no matter how rigorous—can not always capture what happens on the ground when communities begin to talk to each other, when volunteers start mobilizing in palengkes and campuses, or when digital conversations over shared frustrations lead to real-world ballot decisions."

The data scientists are scratching their heads, but their humility is refreshing. Pulse Asia President Ronald Holmes admitted that this election broke patterns. With their last survey held from April 20 to 24, the swing in rankings between that period and election day on May 12 was statistically jarring. According to Peter Cayton, a statistician from the University of the Philippines, surveys are snapshots frozen in time. Voter sentiment, however, is not, especially not in a volatile political climate, where grassroots movements can shift momentum overnight.

Here is the crux: statistical sampling—no matter how rigorous—can not always capture what happens on the ground when communities begin to talk to each other, when volunteers start mobilizing in palengkes and campuses, or when digital conversations over shared frustrations lead to real-world ballot decisions. The sampling method often used in surveys—multi-stage probability sampling—can only reflect what people are thinking at that specific moment. If major events, endorsements, or opinion shifts occur within the gap before the elections, they go uncaptured.

Bam and Kiko's campaign was textbook understated. Without loud rallies or extravagant jingles, they worked like seasoned public servants. Their volunteers, mostly young, motivated, and organized by shared experiences of governance, were the unseen hands behind this win. The so-called 'kakampinks'—supporters of the Robredo campaign—had not disappeared. They evolved into a quieter but equally determined force. And while Aquino and Pangilinan distanced themselves from overt party affiliations, they never disowned their roots. Instead, they expanded the definition of principled politics to include independence and pragmatism.

Late-stage endorsements also tipped the balance. Aquino got a nod from Iglesia ni Cristo, long known for its bloc voting, and Jesus is Lord Church. Pangilinan also received backing from JIL, plus that of MILF's United Bangsamoro Justice Party (UBJP) and a few key mayors in vote-rich areas. While such endorsements may not always sway entire provinces, they help create what sociologists call "bandwagon moments"—pivotal cues that influence undecided voters.

Still, this is not to say the surveys failed entirely. They reflected broad trends, yes. Bong Go's consistent top rank validated that. But they missed the fine print. They did not see Rodante Marcoleta sneaking into the top six. They did not foresee Akbayan topping the party-list vote despite not ranking in the pre-election top five. Conversely, high survey rankers like Ben Tulfo, Abby Binay, and Bong Revilla dropped out of the Magic 12 entirely.

There is a statistical explanation here. With margins of error of ±3% nationally and ±6% for regional subgroups (based on 1,200 to 1,800 respondents), movement of 8 to 10 positions is within the realm of possibility, especially for candidates within a clustered range. Jose Ramon Albert of the Philippine Institute for Development Studies emphasized that fluctuations are natural. Voter preferences can crystallize in the last 10 to 14 days before elections. The survey cannot, and should not, replace voter reflection. It is a guide, not a guarantee.

It is also time to rethink how we read the youth vote. Pulse Asia did not stratify by age in its last pre-election survey. As Holmes noted, the youth vote—particularly millennials and Gen Z—might have slipped past their radar. Yet, this vote may have made the biggest impact. Platforms like Facebook, Instagram, X, Discord, Reddit, and TikTok became ground zero for civic education and political discourse. Candidates with substance, regardless of their visibility, were dissected in long threads and crowd-sourced infographics. This tech-savvy electorate did not just tweet; it voted.

Aquino's platform of strengthening RA 10931—the Universal Access to Quality Tertiary Education Act—landed with particular resonance in a country grappling with learning poverty and inaccessible higher education. Pangilinan's proposed expansion of a national feeding program and support for agricultural resilience offered immediate, tangible solutions amid rising food prices. These were not just talking points. These were plans rooted in long-standing advocacies, and voters recognized that.

Statistical noise cannot drown out a signal when people decide they have had enough of mediocrity. These victories show that in a sea of celebrity politics, there is still room for quiet integrity. These wins do not declare that traditional surveys are obsolete, but they do challenge us to interpret them with nuance. Public opinion is not data alone; it is context, memory, movement, and momentum.

Perhaps the real lesson here is a simple one: track records matter. Even in a culture often accused of amnesia, voters eventually remember who showed up, who delivered, and who stood for something bigger than self. Aquino and Pangilinan may have surprised pundits, but they did not surprise those who paid attention. Their story is less about defeating giants and more about honoring legacies.

This 2025 midterm election reminded the nation that political resurrection is not a miracle. It is earned. And when people come together—not for a personality, but for a cause--the results, though statistically improbable, become politically inevitable. Whether surveys will catch up to this reality remains to be seen. But as voters have shown, their judgment runs deeper than numbers on a page. _

Doc H fondly describes himself as a "student of and for life" who, like many others, aspires to a life-giving and why-driven world grounded in social justice and the pursuit of happiness. His views do not necessarily reflect those of the institutions he is employed or connected with.

READING BETWEEN THE SENATE VOTES

EDITORIAL

It did not take a clairvoyant to read the room this election season. The 2025 senatorial results, still humming in partial tallies but clear in trend, offer more than a list of names. They whisper of change, signal a recalibration, and murmur a subtle but telling critique of a political culture long warped by celebrity and machinery. While traditional politics may not have collapsed overnight, this election undoubtedly upended its foundations. The message: the Filipino electorate, especially the younger ones, are beginning to vote not just with memory, but with mindfulness.

This year, Gen Z voters did not just show up. They showed out. Many of them were first-time voters, and their numbers will only grow in 2028. This bloc, armed with digital fluency and issue-oriented sensibilities, did not simply latch onto names from billboards or trending hashtags. They clicked through platforms, tuned in to meeting de avance's, and fact-checked campaign claims. Apps like Vote Pilipinas, Tayo Na!, and even Google Trends offered accessible summaries and comparative tools that influenced this cohort more than TV jingles ever could. What emerged is a generation that is reshaping elections into civic education and engagement.

> "The 2025 midterm elections are not a revolution, but they are a signal. They mark a subtle shift from theatricality to thoughtfulness, from noise to nuance."

Gone are the days when dancing budots on a campaign stage guaranteed a Senate seat. The electorate has started to demand more than mere visibility or self-proclaimed piety; it wants viability and consistency in action. Voters left behind a surprising number of showbiz hopefuls and viral vloggers, even those with massive social media and cult-like followings. The gap between fame and qualification has finally begun to matter more. This should be a lesson to political handlers: charisma must now come with coherence, and TikTok presence cannot cover up for a lack of platform.

Interestingly, we cannot simply attribute the victories of Kiko Pangilinan and Bam Aquino to nostalgia or a romanticized opposition. Their campaign success stemmed from sheer ground hustle and, more curiously, the brokenness of the Uniteam that once ruled the 2022 elections. Internal rifts within the BBM-Duterte axis allowed old allies of the people to return, not in fanfare, but in quiet, persistent campaigning. LGU endorsements and changes in traditional alliances created gaps that volunteers and progressive coalitions diligently widened. Their comeback is not just a return, it is a reckoning.

Protest votes tell an equally compelling story. Despite limited funding and weak political infrastructure, left-of-center and far-left-leaning candidates—labor leaders, farmers, fishermen, and community organizers—managed to draw millions of votes. There is growing frustration bubbling below the surface, and it seeks authentic representation. Even though they did not win, we should not disregard their numbers. People are starting to pay more attention to experience, integrity, and education. Academic rigor, administrative exposure, and issue literacy are slowly becoming currency again. There is hope in that trend, even if the transformation remains incomplete. The hunger for structural change is real, even if the road remains uphill.

Another clear takeaway is the waning influence of the so-called Iglesia bloc vote. In previous years, INC endorsements could practically assure a Senate seat. But in 2025, several endorsed bets failed to crack the top 12. Whether this is due to evolving voter independence or internal fissures within the religious bloc, the old guarantees are not as guaranteed anymore. It is a small but symbolic shift in our electoral map.

Surveys, once considered infallible, also experienced a decline in credibility. Candidates like Aquino and Pangilinan outperformed their predicted ranks by as many as 10 notches. This disparity may suggest late surges, silent voters, or perhaps the quiet refusal of respondents to disclose their true preferences in a climate of political fear and digital surveillance. In her decoding of voter psychology, Rappler researcher Jodesz Gavilan noted that while numbers tell stories, they may not always capture emotion, hesitation, or strategic silence.

Then, there is the curious resilience of the Duterte brand, still holding ground in Mindanao and among Classes D and E. Despite the ICC cloud and shady narratives, Bong Go and Bato dela Rosa's victories suggest that the checkered form "tapang" and "malasakit" continues to resonate with many. Their victory could be interpreted as a pushback against what is seen as a cold, unfeeling technocracy in Manila. That said, Duterte's ten whittled down to three may signal a waning grip, especially outside their strongholds.

One cannot ignore, too, the fact that while vote buying remains rampant, its impact appears diluted. The focus now is on social media ads, influencer partnerships, and digital presence. Candidates now spend much on boosted posts, not just via envelopes. Although this situation is not ideal, it indicates a shift in persuasion efforts towards platforms that are also frequented by fact-checking communities and youth groups. This at least creates some friction in the scrutiny process.

Meanwhile, there is something quietly poetic in how voters, particularly the youth, have embraced political discernment not by lectures, but by lived frustration. The unchecked inflation, healthcare woes, labor issues, continuing education crises, fiscal shortfalls, and culture of impunity have educated people more than any debate stage could. When a shallow senatorial candidate fails to grasp basic legislative duties or mumbles through interviews, voters now pay attention. Representation becomes more than just symbolic during periods of national insecurity: it becomes crucial for survival. The Senate is no longer a stage for re-enactments of action movies or comedy sketches. It is a deliberative chamber with real consequences.

Still, one could only imagine what might have been if names like Leni Robredo, Chel Diokno, and Leila de Lima ran under the Senate banner. Their absence may have left room for others to rise, but their probable wins, amid the cracks in traditional alliances, could have accelerated the return of checks and balances. Instead, some of them smartly took the party-list or local government route—a move that could spread their influence across more sectors. It was a tactical retreat that, in time, may prove wise in 2028.

The 2025 midterm elections are not a revolution, but they are a signal. They mark a subtle shift from theatricality to thoughtfulness, from noise to nuance. The country is not yet rid of dynasties, gimmicks, or traditional power plays. But there is now a visible resistance to all of that. It is not loud. It is not flashy. It does not even trend on social media for long. But it is there. It inspires. And it is growing. This is evident in various settings such as classrooms, churches, conversations, social media, community centers, and coffee shop debates. The electorate is learning to engage—not with blind trust, but with sharpened focus and cautious resolve.

And that, perhaps, is the most hopeful message of all.

Artificial Intelligence: A Friend or a Foe

BY HEART ASHLEY ESPIRITU

In an era where technology evolves at a lightning pace, few advancements have sparked as much debate, fascination, and concern as Artificial Intelligence (AI). From self-driving cars to personalized recommendations on streaming platforms, AI is increasingly intertwined with everyday life. But as AI becomes more powerful and pervasive, it raises a fundamental question: Is AI a friend that will enhance human potential, or is it a foe that threatens jobs, privacy, and even our autonomy?

AI, in its simplest form, refers to machines designed to perform tasks that typically require human intelligence, such as understanding language, recognizing images, and making decisions. Over the past few decades, AI has made remarkable strides, largely due to advancements in machine learning, deep learning, and neural networks. These technologies allow machines to "learn" from data, improving their accuracy and ability to perform complex tasks.

For instance, AI-powered tools like chatbots, virtual assistants, and medical diagnostic systems are already reshaping industries. In healthcare, AI has been used to detect early signs of diseases like cancer, while in business, it's revolutionizing customer service with personalized interactions. The potential benefits are vast: greater efficiency, cost savings, and the creation of innovative new solutions.

Proponents of AI argue that it has the power to be an invaluable tool for humanity. One of the most significant benefits is the potential for increased productivity. With AI handling repetitive and mundane tasks, people can focus on more creative and complex activities that require emotional intelligence and critical thinking. This shift could lead to an era of greater innovation, where humans and AI work together to solve pressing challenges like climate change, poverty, and health crises.

Moreover, AI can improve access to information and services. In education, AI can provide personalized learning experiences, catering to each student's individual needs. In developing nations, AI-driven technologies can help bridge the gap in healthcare, offering remote diagnostics and consultations to underserved populations.

AI's ability to process vast amounts of data and uncover hidden patterns also positions it as a game-changer in scientific research. With its help, researchers can analyze complex data sets more quickly, accelerating discoveries in fields like genomics, physics, and space exploration.

Despite its potential, AI also raises a number of significant concerns. One of the most pressing issues is the impact on employment. As AI becomes more adept at performing tasks traditionally done by humans, an example of this is a news topic from GMA Integrated News, an ai sportscaster to bring news and updates for the NCAA season 99 which received major backlash especially those that are working in that field, there are fears that widespread job displacement could occur. In sectors such as manufacturing, transportation, and customer service, automation could lead to large-scale layoffs, leaving millions of workers without stable income or opportunities for retraining.

Furthermore, AI has the potential to exacerbate existing inequalities. While AI-driven technologies promise to improve access to services, they can also be biased. Algorithms used in hiring, law enforcement, and lending have been found to disproportionately disadvantage marginalized groups, perpetuating societal inequalities.

Privacy is another major concern. AI systems often rely on vast amounts of personal data to function effectively. From social media profiles to credit card purchases, our data is constantly being collected and analyzed. While this can lead to personalized experiences, it also opens the door to surveillance, data breaches, and potential misuse by both private corporations and governments.

Ethical dilemmas also abound in the realm of AI. Who is responsible when an AI makes a mistake, such as a self-driving car causing an accident? As AI systems become more autonomous, questions about accountability, safety, and decision-making will only become more complicated.

As we stand on the brink of an AI-driven future, it's clear that the technology is neither inherently good nor bad. Like any powerful tool, the impact of AI depends on how we choose to develop, deploy, and regulate it. To harness AI's potential while mitigating its risks, thoughtful and ethical governance is essential.

One critical area of focus is education and workforce retraining. Governments and organizations must invest in programs that equip workers with the skills needed for the AI-driven economy. By fostering a culture of lifelong learning, society can ensure that people remain adaptable in the face of technological change.

Ethical frameworks and transparency in AI development are also crucial. Developers must be held accountable for creating fair and unbiased algorithms, and AI systems should be transparent, allowing for scrutiny and oversight. Collaboration between governments, tech companies, and civil society will be key to ensuring that AI is used in ways that benefit all of humanity, rather than just a select few.

Ultimately, whether AI is a friend or a foe depends largely on how it is wielded. In the hands of thoughtful, responsible developers and policymakers, AI can unlock unprecedented opportunities for human advancement. However, if left unchecked, its potential for harm cannot be ignored. As we continue to integrate AI into every aspect of our lives, it is up to us to navigate the complexities of this powerful technology, ensuring that it serves as a force for good rather than a source of division and harm.

The future of AI is not predetermined. It is a story that we are still writing, and how it unfolds will depend on the choices we make today. By approaching AI with caution, foresight, and ethical responsibility. This is not the top of this evolving mechanism, there is more to return from it, who knows what AI can do within us in the future, maybe it'll be a better tomorrow or a whole society of robots.

The Wednesday HERALD-T*
Published every Wednesday with editorial office at #68 Malakas St., Brgy. San Gregorio, San Pablo City, 4000 Laguna
Tel. No. (049) 5031308
CP# 0948 1883430 / 0966 9230059
e-mail: heraldgroup96@gmail.com
website: https://thewednesdayherald.net

SECOND CLASS MAIL PERMIT RENEWAL at SAN PABLO CITY POST OFFICE UNDER PERMIT NO. 2024-22

NENA ESTRELLADO-MALLARI
--FOUNDER--

MARIA SHERYL IVY M.ASPREC
--PUBLISHER (ON LEAVE)--

VLADIMIR G.ASPREC
--ACTING PUBLISHER & EDITOR--

DANIEL IAN M.ASPREC
--ASSOCIATE EDITOR--

ANABELE PAGON
--Business Manager--

ROLANDO A. INCIONG
PAOLO MANUEL FULE
RUBEN E.TANINGCO
--Contributors--

ATTY. MARIE CHRISTINE C. ANONUEVO
--Legal Consultant--

SUBSCRIPTION RATES
Six months P750.00
One Year P1,500.00

COMMERCIAL AD RATE
P200.00/col. cm.

EXTRA-JUDICIAL FORECLOSURE AND COURT NOTICES RATE
P160.00/col. cm.

MEMBER:
Philippine Press Institute
Since 1964
The National Association of Newspapers

PAPER PH
PRIME ALLIANCE OF PUBLISHERS, EDITORS & REPORTERS OF THE PHILS., (PAPER.PH) INC.

SEVEN LAKES PRESS CORPS

DISCLAIMER: The views and opinions expressed herein are those of the authors, writers and contributors and do not necessarily reflect the official policy or position of the editorial board.

The Wednesday HERALD
https://thewednesdayherald.net
email: heraldgroup96@gmail.com
ONE OF LAGUNA'S OLDEST AND MOST TRUSTED WEEKLY NEWSPAPER
Vol. 44 No. 28
May 28-June 3, 2025

MPT South kicks off Road Safety Month with 'Drayberks: Ready 4 Safety' campaign

...from p. 1

The following major transport and terminal partners also attended the event: Parañaque Integrated Terminal Exchange (PITX), One Ayala Terminal, and advocacy organizations like ACTO; bus companies such as TAS Trans Corp., Erjohn & Almark Transit Corp. Co., Don Aldrin Transport Inc., Saulog Transit, and Jasper Jean Services Inc.; UV groups such as DIPTA-MOA, United 12 Corp., TVTAP; modern and traditional jeepney groups such as Paliparan 3, Kapit Bisig Transport, PABODA, CAMBIO, and Universal Transport; and Philippine Multimodal Transport and Logistics Association Inc. as a representative for the logistics sector.

Mr. Jose Ma. K. Lim, the President and CEO of Metro Pacific Tollways Corporation (MPTC), delivered the welcome remarks. He emphasized the critical role expressway operators play not just in building infrastructure, but also in promoting a culture of safety on and beyond their roads. He stated, "This project is just one of the many ways MPTC demonstrates its unwavering commitment to the safety of all road users. We believe that true progress in road safety comes through collaboration—by working hand-in-hand with government, private partners, and the communities we serve."

The main event was the unveiling of the new Road Safety Campaign of MPT South, "Drayberks: Ready 4 Safety" Campaign, which was led by Ms. Arlette V. Capistrano, MPT South Vice President for Communication and Stakeholder Management. The Drayberks program, first introduced in 2018, has evolved into a well-regarded platform for promoting road discipline. Now in its sixth year, Drayberks has been recognized as a model road safety program, most recently earning a Bronze Stevie® Award in the Innovation in Communications/Public Relations category at the 2025 Asia-Pacific Stevie Awards. With the refreshed Ready 4 Safety campaign, MPT South aims to reach drivers of all classifications—from public utility drivers and logistics operators to private motorists—through updated modules grounded in four key points: Responsible driving, expressway rules, pre-trip vehicle inspection, and practicing discipline on the road.

"'Ready 4 Safety' strengthens our promise to equip every driver with the knowledge and values needed to navigate roads safely—not only for their own benefit, but for everyone's," Capistrano shared during the unveiling.

The event culminated in a powerful moment as participants stood together to recite the Drayberks Pledge, led by MPT South OIC Elnora D. Rumawak. This collective commitment to safe, disciplined, and responsible driving was further solidified with a symbolic pledge signing, uniting government agencies, transport groups, and local leaders under one shared goal.

As the curtains closed on this milestone celebration, MPT South reaffirmed its mission: that beyond building roads, it is building a culture of safety, accountability, and readiness—one driver, one community at a time.

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT OF ESTATE WITH WAIVER OF RIGHTS

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **REMIGIO S. ARGANA**, who died intestate, left a one-half (1/2) interest, rights and participation over two (2) parcels of land covered by Transfer Certificate of Title No. 075-2011001523 located at Brgy. San Miguel, San Pablo City and covered by Transfer Certificate of Title No. 075-2011001522 located at Brgy. San Miguel, San Pablo City which had been the subject of an "Extrajudicial Settlement of Estate of the late Remigio S. Argana With Waiver of Rights" among his legal heirs before Notary Public Ereczurex A. Lanzuela as per Doc. No. 437; Page No. 89; Book No. 68; Series of 2025.

TWH – May 28, June 4 & 11, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT OF ESTATE

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **Spouses JOSE GONZALES and PILAR NAVAREZ**, who died intestate on March 24, 1984 and Oct. 25, 1998 respectively, left a parcel of land situated in Maitim, Bay, Laguna covered by Transfer Certificate of Title No. EP-391 which had been extrajudicially settled among their heirs before Notary Public Atty. Nonato C. Arcillas as per Doc. No. 59; Page No. 13; Book No. 130; Series of 2025.

TWH – May 28, June 4 & 11, 2025

The silent struggle: How rising heat threatens Filipino Farmers



BY ALEXIS M. PANSOY

In our countryside, where fields full of greens, and Filipino farmers rise with the sun. Years of working, Their hands are tough and through their faces show stories of hard days. But now, their challenge grow even harder. The rising heat index, how hot it feels when humidity is added to the temperature is turning their daily routines into battles against the sun.

Many parts of the Philippines have recorded dangerous heat index levels in recent months, reaching 42° C sometimes. For workers specifically farmers who work outdoors, this kind of heat can be harmful, even deadly.

The high heat makes it harder for them to stay in the fields, meaning their work hours and farming can be shorter and slower. Aside from health problems the heat index can also affects the crops. The soil dries up because of too much heat and damages plants. Our Farmers are now trying to adjust. As early as 4am, some are starting their work while others build shelters in the fields for shade. Drinking water is advice from the Government agencies and local groups to stay safe in heat. Staying indoors is not an option for many farmers. If they don't work, they don't eat.

We all know that being in the field of farming has never been easy, but the rising heat add a new layer of difficulty and struggles to an already tough job. As the climate change continues, Filipino farmers are one of the most affected. Knowing that they are the backbone of the country's food supply, but in reality they often suffer in silence. Supporting them through better tools, education, and protection is not just an act of kindness, but a necessity for everyone who depends on the food they grow under the scorching sun.

PhilHealth Regional Office IV-A, nakilahok sa Pahiyas Festival

...mula sa p. 1

Ang Pahiyas Festival ay kilala sa mga tahanang may makukulay na dekorasyong gawa sa mga ani, kiping (hugis-dahon na wafer mula sa bigas), at mga lokal na handicrafts. Ang mga makukulay na dekorasyon ay simbolo ng pasasalamat para sa masaganang ani, kung saan bawat tahanan ay nagpapakita ang kanilang sining at pagkamalikhain.

Bukod sa pakikilahok sa parada, naglagay ang LHIO Lucena ng information booth mula May 14-15, 2025 upang magbigay ng tulong sa pagpaparehistro ng mga nais maging miyembro, pag-update ng records ng mga miyembro na, at pagbibigay ng impormasyon tungkol sa benepisyo, kabilang ang PhilHealth Konsulta Package.

Samantala sa Gumaca, aktibong nakilahok ang mga kawani ng LHIO Gumaca at regional office sa Arana't Baluarte Festival, na kilala sa natatanging tradisyon ng pagsabit ng mga palamuti mula sa prutas at katutubong pagkain sa mga baluarte.

Bilang bahagi ng selebrasyon, naglagay din ng information booth ang LHIO Gumaca na nagsimula pa noong May 13, 2025 kung saan namahagi sila ng flyers sa mga taong pumunta sa pagdiriwang upang ipaalam sa kanila ang mga programa at serbisyong ipinagkakaloob ng PhilHealth. Ito din ay naging daan para tumugon sa mga katanungan ukol sa pagpapamiyembro, updating ng records, at iba pang nais nilang malaman sa PhilHealth.

Sa pamamagitan ng pakikilahok sa mga lokal na tradisyon at kasayahan, pinagtitibay ng PRO IV-A ang layunin nitong mapadali ang pag-access sa serbisyo ng PhilHealth at maipalaganap ang impormasyon sa mga miyembro nito. **(RFV)**

REPUBLIC OF THE PHILIPPINES
REGIONAL TRIAL COURT
FOURTH JUDICIAL REGION
BRANCH 108, CABUYAO CITY, LAGUNA
Official Contact No.: 09514918839
Official Email Address: rtc2cby108@judiciary.gov.ph

NOTICE OF EXTRA JUDICIAL FORECLOSURE
EJF NO. 199-C-2024-EJ

Upon Petition for Extra-Judicial Foreclosure of Real Estate Mortgage Under Act 3135, as amended, filed by **HOME DEVELOPMENT MUTUAL FUND**, mortgagee, against **SPS. RAMON V. SAMAN AND CRESENCIA N. SAMAN**, mortgagor/s, both of legal age, Filipino citizens, postal address at LOT 8 BLOCK 6 CASERES ST., GRAN SEVILLE, BANLIC, CABUYAO, LAGUNA, RAMON V. SAMAN is hereby represented by his wife CRESENCIA N. SAMAN as his Attorney-in-Fact, to satisfy the mortgage indebtedness which as of October 22, 2024 amounted to **FIVE HUNDRED EIGHTY TWO THOUSAND NINE HUNDRED FIFTY TWO PESOS & 19/100 (Php 582,952.19)** inclusive of interest and other charges the undersigned Deputy Sheriff will sell at public auction on **July 17, 2025 at 2:00 o'clock pm** in afternoon soon thereafter at the office of the Clerk of Court & Ex-Officio Sheriff, RTC Branch 108, 2/F Unit 7, New Annijo Commercial Bldg. along National Highway, Brgy. Sala Cabuyao City, Laguna (Besides Royal Cable Office) across Cabuyao Public Cemetery, to the highest bidder, for Cash or Manager's Check and in the Philippine Currency, the following described properties with all its improvement to wit:

TRANSFER CERTIFICATE OF TITLE NO. T-755461

A PARCEL OF LAND (LOT 8 BLK. 6, OF THE SUBD. PLAN, PSD-04-150614, A PORTION OF LOT 4-H, PSD-19808, LRC REC. NO.), SITUATED IN THE BRGY. OF BANLIC, MUN. OF CABUYAO, PROV. OF LAGUNA, ISLAND OF LUZON. BOUNDED ON THE XXXX CONTAINING AN AREA OF ONE HUNDRED (100) SQ. METERS x x x.

All sealed bids must be submitted to the undersigned on the above stated time and date.

In the event the public auction should not take place on the above-mentioned date by reason of fortuitous events/special holidays, it shall be held on July 24, 2025 at 2:00 o'clock pm without further notice.

City of Cabuyao, Laguna, May 2, 2025.

(Sgd.) **ALEX A. MENDOZA**
Sheriff IV

Copy Furnished:
HOME DEVELOPMENT MUTUAL FUND
The Petron Mega Plaza Building No. 358
Sen. Gil Puyat Avenue, Makati City

SPS. RAMON V. SAMAN AND CRESENCIA N. SAMAN
1.) Lot 8 Block 6 Caseres St., Gran Seville, Banlic, Cabuyao, Laguna
2.) Lot 8 Block 6 Gran Seville, Banlic, Cabuyao, Laguna

MARIA VICTORIA D. CAPIRALC/O ATTY. MELANIO A. BADENAS JR.
Attorney-In-Fact, GCCS & ASSOCIATES CORP.
RM. 209 Megastate Bldg., No. 737 G. Araneta Ave., Tatalon, Quezon City

The Wednesday Herald
San Pablo City
May 28, June 4 & 11, 2025

Laguna's April 2025 inflation rose slightly to 2.6 percent

...from p. 1

during the month from 0.4 percent in the previous month.

Meanwhile, decrease in inflation rate was observed in Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages at 3.9 percent from 5.0 percent; Health at 1.1 percent from 1.3 percent; and Transport at -1.0 percent from -0.2 percent. The indices of the rest of the commodity groups retained their respective previous month's annual rates.

Food inflation at the provincial level slowed down to 3.8 percent in April 2025 from 5.1 percent in the previous month. In April 2024, food inflation was recorded at 3.7 percent.

The downtrend of food inflation in April 2025 was primarily brought about by the lower inflation rate of fish and other seafood at 3.9 percent in April 2025 from 8.4 percent in previous month. This was followed by the food g r o u p of Vegetables, tubers, plantains, cooking bananas and pulses at 0.9 percent during the month from 7.7 percent in March 2025.

On the contrary, faster annual growth rates during the month were observed in the indices of the following food groups:

a. Oils and fats, 12.4 percent from 10.6 percent.

b. Meat and other parts of slaughtered land animals, 10.5 percent from 9.5 percent;

c. Sugar, confectionery and desserts, -1.3 percent from -1.4 percent; and

d. Corn, 12.8 percent from 5.7 percent.

DAVELARA GAMING CORPORATION

STL WINNING NUMBERS

	1st Draw	2nd Draw	3rd Draw
05/19/2025	34/19	29/22	21/31
05/20/2025	05/14	12/14	01/02
05/21/2025	18/16	34/33	32/22
05/22/2025	31/29	29/17	34/28
05/23/2025	09/13	29/32	12/03
05/24/2025	01/19	38/27	05/33
05/25/2025	32/03	20/20	07/06

Vol. 44 No. 28
May 28-June 3, 2025
The Wednesday HERALD
https://thewednesdayherald.net
email: heraldgroup96@gmail.com
ONE OF LAGUNA'S OLDEST AND MOST TRUSTED WEEKLY NEWSPAPER

Mount Cristobal: A Bewitching Beacon Beyond the Horizon

Written and Captured by:
Giiane Margarette C. Marasigan



Nestled quietly in the lush heart of Brgy. Pinagdanlayan, Sitio Lukong, Dolores, Quezon, Lukong's view deck oversees the towering picturesque of Mount Cristobal, a giant that pierces the horizon — a view one cannot escape.

Mount Cristobal, infamously known as the "Devil's Mountain," is an active stratovolcano that sits between the provinces of Laguna and Quezon in the Philippines. Yet despite its breathtaking beauty, Cristobal is particularly known for the eerie and supernatural tales shared by both locals and mountaineers. This giant serves as a stark reminder that beauty and mystery can co-exist, stirring both awe and fear, creating a sense of curiosity and admiration. Despite the stories, many are still drawn to its raw beauty and the magnetic pull of its mystery. Some come for the peace, others for the thrill of the unknown. The trail is quiet, the trees often wrapped in fog, and the silence feels unusually heavy. It's a place where nature feels alive and maybe, something else does too.

As the sun dips and paints the sky in streaks of amber and crimson, Cristobal's silhouette becomes even more striking, its secrets seeming to grow darker with the fading light. For those standing at Lukong's view deck, gazing into the looming distance, it's a view that lingers not just in the eye, but also penetrates one's soul.

The Next Big Scare: 'Thin Threads' and the Rise of Filipino Horror Gaming

by Eunisse Magno

Supernatural themes have long been dominating the world of horror games where the terrifying unknown and uncanny lurk in the shadows. 'Thin Threads' embraces this potent fear while delving even deeper. As players guide a father back to his meager home after a fruitless search for scraps, the game expertly weaves a haunting narrative of a family battling not just the supernatural, but also the grim reality of poverty. It's in this powerful blend that 'Thin Threads' finds its most profound and unsettling terror.

Thin Threads is a first-person psychological horror game that focuses on the struggles of a family to survive poverty, providing the player a switch of perspectives as the point of view switches between the three family members. The game introduces us early to the struggles of poverty and the guilt of a father who cannot provide for his family that causes the strain between the family. As the game progresses, we see the blend of supernatural and psychological horror through the hauntings of a supernatural entity and the effects of poverty on those who suffer from it.

Aside from its storytelling, the game ensures that the player is on their guard at all times, using the environment and silent atmosphere to provide an eerie and unsettling feeling while playing, giving every player that fear of anticipation where most games use loud jumpscares, the game opted for silent ones, making your skin crawl. Who would've thought that a piece of cloth for a door could instill so much fear just by passing through it? The game's visuals also provide a sense of realism, providing the viewer a beautifully crafted scene every turn from just a tight budget.

'Thin Threads' isn't just another horror game, it is a game forged from the passion for game creation, led and founded by Keneth Agar and his small team from Solitary Studios, hailing all the way from Los Banos, Laguna. The developers have provided a visually appealing and amazing storytelling horror game to its audience, utilizing their passion for game creation to create an experience that not only scares but also resonates with the real-world struggles faced by many. This intention is identifiable in the game's unflinching portrayal of poverty and its haunting integration with the psychological and supernatural horrors.

The release of 'Thin Threads' on February 18, 2025, and its subsequent playthroughs by influential streamers such as CaseOh, 8-Bitryan, and Kubz Scouts, mark a significant moment for Filipino game development. This global spotlight highlights the artistic prowess and storytelling capabilities emerging from the local indie scene. "Thin Threads' proves that passion and creativity, even within budget constraints, can produce deeply engaging and terrifying experiences that resonate with a broad audience, establishing a strong case for the recognition and support of Filipino game developers on the world stage.

The growing recognition of Filipino independent game development on the global stage underscores the talent and creativity within the local scene. The journey of 'Thin Threads' reminds us that genuine passion and a dedication to crafting enjoyable experiences are essential for a game's success. Whether you're a fan of horror or games with good storytelling and great visuals, give 'Thin Threads' a shot.

Coco Festival 2025: San Pablo City's Celebration of Culture, Community, and the "Tree of Life"

by Kashmere Einielie Nicholine V. Ciolo

As the dawn's golden light bathed San Pablo City on January 9, 2025, an air of excitement and festivity filled the streets. The much-anticipated Coco Festival, marking its 30th year, burst into life with vibrant colors, lively music, and the irresistible scent of coconut delicacies wafting through the city. That week-long celebration was more than just a festival, it was a heartfelt homage to the coconut palm, lovingly dubbed the "tree of life," whose leaves, fruits, and wood have been intricately woven into the fabric of San Pablo's identity for generations.

The Coco Festival began in 1996 as a tribute to San Pablo's primary agricultural bounty, the coconut. Alongside honoring the city's patron saint, St. Paul the First Hermit, the festival grew into one of Laguna province's most anticipated cultural events. Over three decades, it evolved into a stage where history, tradition, and creativity converged. For the locals, this festival was a time to reflect on their heritage while celebrating the resilience and resourcefulness that coconut farming inspired. It was a shared pride that blossomed in every street dance step, every carefully crafted float, and every coconut-infused dish. One of the festival's most breathtaking events was the street dancing competition. Hundreds of students from San Pablo's schools made intricate costumes fashioned from coconut husks, shells, and leaves, transforming the streets into a living canvas of artistry and culture. Their choreographed dances told stories of the city's history, the coconut's vital role, and the spirit of community that bound the people together. Alongside the dancers, the grand float parade mesmerized people. Each float was a labor of love, meticulously designed to depict aspects of San Pablo's culture and the significance of coconut farming. As the floats passed by, cheers erupted, and cameras clicked that captured moments that will be shared for years to come.

As the festival's final night lit up the San Pablo sky with fireworks, the spirit of the Coco Festival lingered in every heart. Through this celebration, San Pablo City honored its past while nurturing a hopeful future, a future where tradition and innovation grow hand in hand. As visitors left the city, many carried with them not just souvenirs or sweet memories, but a deep appreciation for the cultural richness and vibrant energy that define San Pablo. The Coco Festival is a beacon, shining brightly each year to showcase how a simple tree can nurture an entire community's identity and aspirations.The Coco Festival 2025 not only rekindled the city's pride in its roots but also inspired its people to carry the legacy of the coconut into the years to come, proving once again that in every nut lies the story of a community united in joy, creativity, and strength.

NOTICE TO THE PUBLIC

Notice is hereby given that **EUGENIO IMPRESO CAPARROS**, Filipino, married and resident of 22 Maharlika Highway, Lopez, Quezon, died at the age of 70 years old on Dec. 17, 2013 at Medical Center Parañaque Inc., Dr. A. Santos Ave., Sucat Rd., Parañaque City, Metro Manila as per Certificate of Death with Registry No. 2014-118 duly registered at the Office of the City Civil Registrar of Parañaque City, Metro Manila on Jan. 13, 2014.

TWH -- May 28, June 4 & 11, 2025

Rising Above: Pursuing Education Despite the Odds

by Myra C. Fabros

In today's fast-paced and often unpredictable world, pursuing education is not always an easy journey. Many students face a range of challenges—mental health struggles, financial hardship, family responsibilities, and academic pressure. Yet, despite these obstacles, countless young learners continue to press forward, driven by hope, determination, and the dream of a better future.

One of the most admirable qualities of students today is their resilience. Whether attending classes in-person or online, dealing with limited resources, or balancing part-time jobs to support their families, students continue to show remarkable strength. Even during the global pandemic, when schools closed and routines were disrupted, many adapted quickly, showing that learning doesn't stop when times get tough.

Support systems—such as encouraging teachers, understanding parents, and peer networks—also play a key role in helping students overcome difficulties. Additionally, growing awareness about mental health and learning support has helped many learners cope with stress and anxiety more effectively.

The decision to continue one's studies despite hardships is not just about earning a diploma or a degree. It's about personal growth, perseverance, and the courage to keep moving forward when giving up seems easier. Each student who chooses to rise above their circumstances sends a powerful message: that success is not only measured by grades, but by the strength it takes to finish the race.

Education is more than just academics—it is a journey of character-building and self-discovery. And for those who face adversity head-on and keep striving, their achievements are even more meaningful. They are the true examples of strength, resilience, and hope.

The Philippines Is One Big Reality Show — So, Who Deserves to Be Evicted?

by Jovani Orbe

Imagine the Philippines as one massive season of Pinoy Big Brother. Every citizen is a housemate. The omnipresent "Kuya"? It's not a person — it's our future. Quiet, unrelenting, and ever-watchful, it sees everything, like karma, like progress, or the simple cause-and-effect of our collective decisions. Surveillance is constant, courtesy of social media. Weekly tasks come in the form of bills, traffic, work demands, family responsibilities, and neighborhood drama. And yes, there are evictions — people labeled as "toxic," unfollowed, ignored, or left behind while others grow and move forward.

But the real question is: who truly deserves to be evicted?

Let's start with crab mentality — the attitude that resents other people's success. Instead of lifting oneself up, it pulls others down. It appears in whispers like, "They were rich to begin with, that's why it was easy," when someone's business takes off. Rather than celebrating progress, this mindset creates suspicion and division. It slows collective growth, turning potential allies into silent rivals.

Then there's the persistent colonial mentality — the belief that anything foreign is inherently better. A local product is met with doubt: "Is this legit?" But imported goods, no matter the price, are welcomed without question. The same bias applies to ideas: a concept introduced by a Filipino is ignored until echoed by someone from abroad. We even wait for our own artists to go viral overseas before recognizing their worth. It's time to shift the narrative. Pride in our identity, creativity, and potential must start from within.

Toxic positivity is another trait we need to examine. The pressure to "stay strong" or "just smile" often invalidates real emotional struggles. Positivity has power — but not when it's used to dismiss pain. A friend drowning in stress doesn't always need a cheerleader; they need someone who will genuinely ask, "Are you okay?" Empathy is more than optimism — it's presence. It's the courage to listen without immediately trying to fix.

The "bahala na" mentality is equally damaging — the mindset that leaves everything to chance. "Let's see what happens" becomes the excuse for a lack of planning or preparation. It's the person who spends recklessly without saving. Or the entrepreneur who invests in a franchise without research and blames fate when it fails. This kind of thinking must evolve. From blind faith, we move to active readiness. From "bahala na," we shift to "handa na."

Another mindset to challenge is pakikisama over principle. We often choose silence in the face of wrongdoing, just to avoid conflict. But when we ignore offensive jokes, tolerate disrespect, or allow injustice to slide because we don't want to "make a scene," we become complicit. Kindness is not the absence of confrontation — it's the ability to speak truth with respect. Standing up for what's right does not make you difficult. It makes you brave.

And finally, there is toxic hiya — the paralyzing shame that keeps people from stepping forward. So many great ideas go unheard, not because they lacked merit, but because someone was afraid of being labeled "ambisyosa" or "trying hard." People decline speaking engagements, delete their artwork, or downplay their achievements because they fear being seen. But the truth is simple: if you don't lift yourself up, who will?

So what does it take to be the "Big Winner" of this metaphorical house? Just like in the show, we need criteria. A true winner is makatao — guided by compassion and care for others. They are makabayan — unapologetically proud of being Filipino. They are makabago — open to change, technology, and forward-thinking ideas. They practice empathy, not just reaction. They uphold accountability, owning their mistakes and striving to improve. They engage in critical thinking, questioning what they consume instead of blindly accepting it. And they are a global Filipino — able to thrive anywhere in the world, while staying deeply rooted in home.

Why does this matter?

Because if more of us lived by these values, everything begins to shift. We build a smarter electorate — no longer swayed by gimmicks and grandstanding. We support local industries, strengthening the economy from the ground up. We elevate public discourse, creating space for meaningful, not just viral, conversations. We create a more inclusive society — one that welcomes ambition, not mocks it. And we empower a generation not just to scroll, but to speak, act, and lead.

So, housemate — are you ready to evict the toxic traits within yourself? Maybe you won't get a confetti shower or a cash prize, but you just might help build a better Philippines — one decision, one mindset shift, one act of courage at a time.

The cameras are rolling. The future is watching.

Will you rise — or be evicted by your own excuses?



REPUBLIC OF THE PHILIPPINES
REGIONAL TRIAL COURT
FOURTH JUDICIAL REGION
BRANCH 108, CABUYAO CITY, LAGUNA
Official Contact No.: 09514918839
Official Email Address: rtc2cby108@judiciary.gov.ph

NOTICE OF EXTRA JUDICIAL FORECLOSURE EJF NO. 181-C-2024-E.J

Upon Petition for Extra-Judicial Foreclosure of Real Estate Mortgage Under Act 3135, as amended, filed by **HOME DEVELOPMENT MUTUAL FUND**, mortgagee, against **BERNADETE N. PADUA**, mortgagor/s, single, of legal age, Filipino citizen, with postal address at LOT 56 BLOCK 7 SAN ISIDRO HEIGHTS 2 SUBDIVISION, BRGY. BANLIC, CABUYAO, LAGUNA to satisfy the mortgage indebtedness which as of September 24, 2024 amounted to **TWO HUNDRED EIGHTY FIVE THOUSAND ONE PESOS & 09/100 (Php 285,001.09)** inclusive of interest and other charges the undersigned Deputy Sheriff will sell at public auction on **July 3, 2025 at 2:00 o'clock pm** in afternoon or soon thereafter at the office of the Clerk of Court & Ex-Officio Sheriff, RTC Branch 108, 2/F Unit 7, New Annijo Commercial Bldg. along National Highway, Brgy. Sala Cabuyao City, Laguna (Besides Royal Cable Office) across Cabuyao Public Cemetery, to the highest bidder, for Cash or Manager's Check and in the Philippine Currency, the following described properties with all its improvement to wit:

TRANSFER CERTIFICATE OF TITLE NO. 060-2011002411

A PARCEL OF LAND (LOT 56, BLK. 7, OF THE SUBD. PLAN, PSD-04-193030, BEING A PORTION OF LOT 4-G, PSD-19808, LRC REC. NO. 13911), SITUATED IN BO. BANLIC, MUN. OF CABUYAO, PROV. OF LAGUNA, ISLAND OF LUZON. BOUNDED ON THE x x x CONTAINING AN AREA OF THIRTY SIX (36) SQUARE METERS,.

All sealed bids must be submitted to the undersigned on the above stated time and date.

In the event the public auction should not take place on the above-mentioned date by reason of fortuitous events/special holidays, it shall be held on July 10, 2025 at 2:00 o'clock pm without further notice.

City of Cabuyao Laguna
May 2, 2025.

(Sgd.) **ALEX A. MENDOZA**
Sheriff

Copy Furnished:
HOME DEVELOPMENT MUTUAL FUND
The Petron Mega Plaza Building No. 358
Sen Gil Puyat Avenue, Makati City

BERNADETE N. PADUA
1.) Lot 56 Block 7 San Isidro Heights 2 Subdivision, Brgy. Banlic, Cabuyao, Laguna

MARIA VICTORIA D. CAPIRAL C/O ATTY. MELANIO A. BADENAS JR.
Attorney-In-Fact, GCCS & ASSOCIATES CORP.
RM. 209 Megastate Bldg., No. 737 G. Araneta Ave., Tatalon, Quezon City

The Wednesday Herald
San Pablo City
May 28, June 4 & 11, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT OF ESTATE

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **ARNOLD C. ALVAREZ**, who died intestate on March 17, 2025 in Santa Rosa City, Laguna, left a certain share of investment at Sun Life located at BGC, Taguig City and eight (8) parcels of lands, residential and agricultural, described as follows:

• Sunlife Acct. No. 00490415CF01 No. of Shares: 88,824
1) Transfer Certificate of Title (TCT) No. T-229285/589676 situated in Brgy. Don Jose, Sta. Rosa, Laguna
2) Transfer Certificate of Title (TCT) No. T-216107/576546 situated in Brgy. Don Jose, Sta. Rosa, Laguna
3) Transfer Certificate of Title (TCT) No. T-226174/575499 situated in Brgy. Don Jose, Sta. Rosa, Laguna
4) Transfer Certificate of Title (TCT) No. T-375575 situated in Parian, Calamba, Laguna
5) Tax Declaration No. AA-18-0038-00282 (Land) located at Malaking Tatiao, Silang, Cavite
6) Transfer Certificate of Title (TCT) No. T-201,405 situated in Brgy. Lumbangan/Divisoria, Zamboanga City
7) Transfer Certificate of Title (TCT) No. T-211,646 situated in Brgy. Lumbangan/Divisoria, Zamboanga City
8) Transfer Certificate of Title (TCT) No. T-129-2015003745 situated in Brgy. Lumbangan/Divisoria, Zamboanga City

which had been the subject of an "Extrajudicial Settlement of Estate of the Deceased Arnold C. Alvarez" among his lawful surviving heirs before Notary Public Atty. Raymond A. Ramos as per Doc. No. 306; Page No. 63; Book No. 365; Series of 2025.

TWH – May 14, 21 & 28, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT OF ESTATE OF EDILBERTO T. SIMON

NOTICE is hereby given that the estate of the late **EDILBERTO T. SIMON**, who died on December 23, 2019 in Binan City, Laguna, which estate consists of one (1) real property located at San Pedro City covered under TCT No. T-296813 and Shares of Stocks with Petron Corp. and Associated Doctors Clinic of San Pedro, Inc., which estate have been the subject of an "Extrajudicial Settlement of Estate" dated May 19, 2025, between his surviving heirs, under Doc. No. 316; Page No. 65; Book No. XLIV; Series of 2025, under Notary Public ATTY. PAUL GIDEON G. ILAGAN, Notary Public of San Pedro, Laguna.

TWH – May 21, 28 & June 4, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT OF ESTATE WITH DEED OF ABSOLUTE SALE

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **ELADIO ATIENZA DEL MUNDO**, who died intestate on Jan. 9, 2021 in Tiaong, Quezon, left a parcel of land located at Brgy. Lusacan, Tiaong, Quezon covered by Transfer Certificate of Title No. T-473256 which had been extrajudicially settled among his heirs and that the following portions of said land has been sold as follows:

• Lot A-6-G-1 with an area of 288 sq. m. to Rocelle Marie Z. Gesmundo;
• Lot A-6-G-2 with an area of 288 sq. m. to Spouses Jayson Z. Gesmundo and Shyrel F. Gesmundo;
• Lot A-6-G-3 with an area of 288 sq. m. to Angelica G. Misagal;
• Lot A-6-G-4 with an area of 136 sq. m. to Angelica G. Misagal;

before Notary Public Atty. Welhelmina M. Tiania as per Doc. No. 67; Page No. 15; Book No. XII; Series of 2025.

TWH – May 14, 21 & 28, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT OF MOTOR VEHICLE

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **MARIETTA ALBAO ATIENZA**, who died intestate on July 9, 2021 in Calamba City, Laguna, left a personal property described as:

MAKE: ISUZU	ENGINE No.: RZ4EUC8525
SERIES: MU-X RZAE 4X2 L	CHASSIS No.: MPAUCR87GKT001019
BODY TYPE: WAGON	FILE No.: 0401-00001054496
YEAR MODEL: 2020	PLATE No.: DAN7605
C.R No. 36770081-5	O.R No.: 0422-000000434599

which had been the subject of a "Deed of Extrajudicial Settlement of Motor Vehicle" among his heirs before Notary Public Atty. Kenneth M. Deo as per Doc. No. 312; Page No. 64; Book No. 20; Series of 2025.

TWH – May 14, 21 & 28, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **EVA GONZALES GABRIDO**, who died intestate on May 30, 2024 in Sta. Cuz, Laguna, left an unclaimed Separation Payment from Government Service Insurance System (GSIS) which had been the subject of a "Deed of Extrajudicial Settlement" among her heirs before Notary Public Atty. Ernesto S. Salvador Jr. as per Doc. No. 372; Page No. 76; Book No. III; Series of 2025.

TWH – May 14, 21 & 28, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT OF ESTATE

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **CASIMIRO ACUAVERA CABISIDAN**, who died intestate on March 17, 1990 at Kalayaan, Laguna, left three (3) parcels of land described as follows: (1) Original Certificate of Title No. P-7710; (2) RO 505 (23058) of the Registry of Deeds for the Province of Laguna; and (3) Tax Declaration No. 18-0013-01425 issued by the Office of the Provincial and Municipal Assessor of Paete, Laguna which had been the subject of an "Extrajudicial Settlement of Estate" among his heirs before Notary Public Atty. Alexander D. Lao as per Doc. No. 436; Page No. 89; Book No. II; Series of 2025.

TWH – May 14, 21 & 28, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT OF ESTATE WITH SALE

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **GREGORIO TAPALLA and VICTORIA M. TAPALLA**, who died intestate on Oct. 6, 2019 and Sep. 14, 2023 respectively, left a parcel of land described as Lot No. 255 prt with total lot size of 933 sq. m. agricultural land plus 100 sq. m. residential land which had been the subject of an extrajudicial settlement of estate with sale among their heirs before Notary Public Atty. Rufino V. Abuda as per Doc. No. 488; Page No. 99; Book No. II; Series of 2024.

TWH – May 14, 21 & 28, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT OF ESTATE

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **FRANCISCO E. DELA ROSA**, who died intestate on March 27, 2019, left a certain parcel of real property known as Lot 1 of the consol-subd. plan Pcs-04-000933 as his conjugal share of 1/2 portion of said property situated in San Vicente, San Pedro, Laguna covered by Transfer Certificate of Title No. T-264549 which had been extrajudicially settled among his heirs before Notary Public Atty. Peter S. Vega II as per Doc. No. 451; Page No. 91; Book No. VII; Series of 2023.

TWH – May 21, 28 & June 4, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT OF ESTATE OF EVELYN AGNES E. GABILLA

NOTICE is hereby given that the estate of the late EVELYN **AGNES E. GABILLA**, who died on February 17, 2020 in San Pedro City, Laguna, which estate consists of one (1) real property located in San Pedro City, Laguna, covered by TCT No. T-398961, which have been the subject of an "Extrajudicial Settlement of Estate of Evelyn Agnes E. Gabilla" dated May 20, 2025, executed by her surviving heirs, under Doc. No. 338; Page No. 69; Book No. XLIV; Series of 2025, under Notary Public ATTY. PAUL GIDEON G. ILAGAN, Notary Public of San Pedro, Laguna.

TWH – May 28, June 4 & 11, 2025

NOTICE OF SELF-ADJUDICATION

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **GUILLERMA C. DE LEON**, who died intestate on Nov. 25, 2021, left a deposit account with Land Bank of the Philippines under account number 3184-0030-90 which had been the subject of an "Affidavit of Self-Adjudication" among her only surviving heir, Narciso de Leon, before Notary Public Atty. Federico A. Bellosillo Jr. as per Doc. No. 205; Page No. 42; Book No. CX; Series of 2025.

TWH – May 28, June 4 & 11, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT WITH WAIVER OF RIGHTS

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **SEVERINA RARELA DEVARAS and RONALD DEVARAS**, who died intestate on March 9, 2018 and June 21, 2016 respectively, left a real property with improvements located at Brgy. Burgos, Pakil, Laguna covered by TCT No. P-6371 which had been the subject of a "Deed of Extrajudicial Settlement With Waiver of Rights" among their heirs before Notary Public Atty. John Marvin T. Tayabas as per Doc. No. 340; Page No. 69; Book No. II; Series of 2025.

TWH – May 21, 28 & June 4, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT WITH WAIVER OF RIGHTS

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **FRANCISCO SALDAÑA and LEONIDA BESINESE TUBAL**, who died intestate on July 4, 1988 and Jan. 7, 2004 respectively, left a property located at Brgy. Rizal, Pakil, Laguna covered by TD No. 20-0004-00823 Property Identification No. 023-20-0004-019-10 which had been the subject of an "Extrajudicial Settlement With Waiver of Rights" among their heirs before Notary Public Atty. John Marvin T. Tayabas as per Doc. No. 318; Page No. 65; Book No. II; Series of 2025.

TWH – May 21, 28 & June 4, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT WITH WAIVER OF RIGHTS

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **PASCASIO SANTOS ANTAZO and LAURENA DE CELEIS ANTAZO**, who died intestate on April 6, 1994 and Nov. 21, 2008 respectively, left properties located at Brgy. Rizal, Pakil, Laguna covered by TD No. 20-0004-00902 Property Identification No. 023-20-0004-020-36 and TD No. 20-0004-00824 Property Identification No. 023-20-0004-019-1 which had been the subject of an "Extrajudicial Settlement With Waiver of Rights" among their heirs before Notary Public Atty. John Marvin T. Tayabas as per Doc. No. 292; Page No. 60; Book No. II; Series of 2025.

TWH – May 21, 28 & June 4, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **TERESITA BAJA**, who died intestate on Oct. 22, 1999, left a real property covered by TD No. 20-0004-00784 Property Identification No. 023-20-0004-018-29 which had been extrajudicially settlement among her heirs before Notary Public Atty. Ronald L. Solis as per Doc. No. 119; Page No. 25; Book No. 130; Series of 2022.

TWH – May 21, 28 & June 4, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT OF ESTATE WITH WAIVER OF RIGHTS

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **Sps. ROSMINE IMPERIAL and LIGAYA IMPERIAL**, who died intestate on Feb. 3, 2015 and Jan. 18, 2007 respectively, left a real property covered by Tax Declaration No. 02-0039-02058 located at Brgy. San Buenaventura, San Pablo City, Laguna which had been the subject of an "Extrajudicial Settlement of Estate With Waiver of Rights" among their heirs before Notary Public Atty. Lorna T. Ruba as per Doc. No. 214; Page No. 43; Book No. XXXVII; Series of 2025.

TWH – May 21, 28 & June 4, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT WITH DEED OF ABSOLUTE SALE

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **REMEDIOS PABILLAR MACALINTAL**, who died on June 8, 2024, left a parcel of land situated in Brgy. Lamot II, Calauan, Laguna covered by TCT No. 058-2022007353 which had been the subject of a "Deed of Extrajudicial Settlement With Deed of Absolute Sale" among her heirs before Notary Public Atty. John Marvin T. Tayabas as per Doc. No. 126; Page No. 27; Book No. 01; Series of 2024.

TWH – May 21, 28 & June 4, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT OF ESTATE WITH WAIVER OF RIGHTS

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **MARIA CONSIGNADO**, who died intestate on June 1, 1992 at Nagcarlan, Laguna, left a real property located at Barangay Banago, Nagcarlan, Laguna covered by Tax Declaration No. 17-0011-01074 which had been the subject of an "Extrajudicial Settlement of Estate With Waiver of Rights" among her heirs before Notary Public Atty. Jamira M. de Ramos as per Doc. No. 83; Page No. 18; Book No. 8; Series of 2025.

TWH – May 21, 28 & June 4, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT WITH DEED OF ABSOLUTE SALE

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **REMEDIOS PABILLAR MACALINTAL**, who died on June 8, 2024, left a parcel of land situated in Brgy. Lamot II, Calauan, Laguna covered by TCT No. 058-2022007353 which had been the subject of a "Deed of Extrajudicial Settlement With Deed of Absolute Sale" among her heirs before Notary Public Atty. John Marvin T. Tayabas as per Doc. No. 126; Page No. 27; Book No. 01; Series of 2024.

TWH – May 21, 28 & June 4, 2025

NOTICE OF EXTRAJUDICIAL SETTLEMENT OF ESTATE

NOTICE is hereby given that the late **TORIBIO CABISIDAN**, who died intestate on July 22, 1916 at Kalayaan, Laguna, left one (1) parcel of land described as Tax Declaration No. 18-0011-00083 issued by the Office of the Provincial and Municipal Assessor of Paete, Laguna which had been the subject of an "Extrajudicial Settlement of Estate" among his heirs before Notary Public Atty. Alexander D. Lao as per Doc. No. 477; Page No. 97; Book No. II; Series of 2025.

TWH – May 14, 21 & 28, 2025